

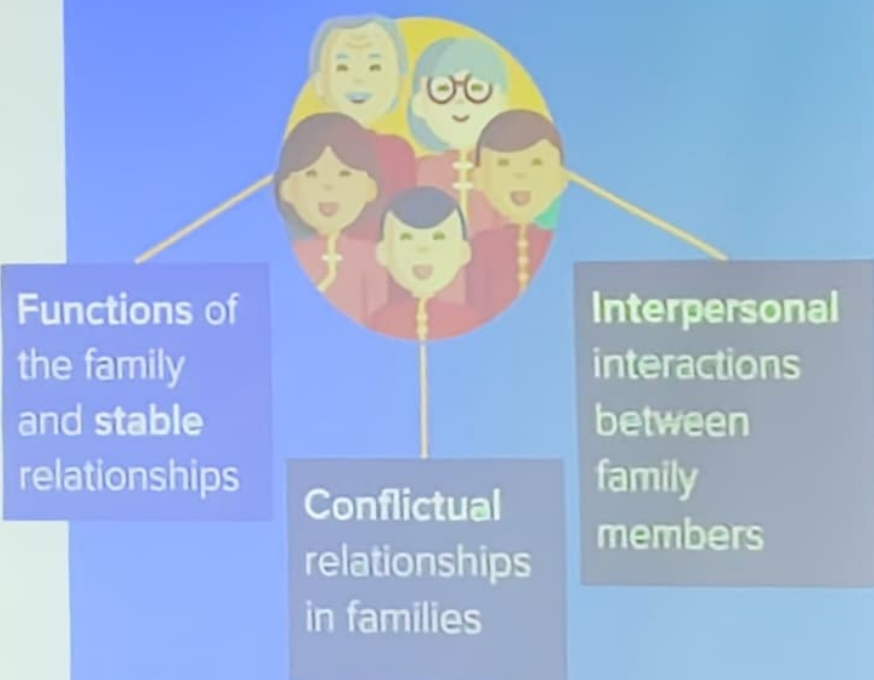
Development of sociological thinking

- Diverse approaches
- Sociologists don't always agree

Why?

Because human behaviours and societies are complex

Example: Family can be analysed in different ways



Development of sociological thinking

Facts/Empirical data



Theories

Theories help explain
facts

“...facts do *not* speak for
themselves” (Giddens,
2009)

—

The origin of Sociology

Two events that led to the development of Sociology:

1. French Revolution - 1789 in France
2. Industrial Revolution - Mid-18th century in Europe



Religious explanations



Scientific explanations



Example

Universe
revolves
around the
Earth

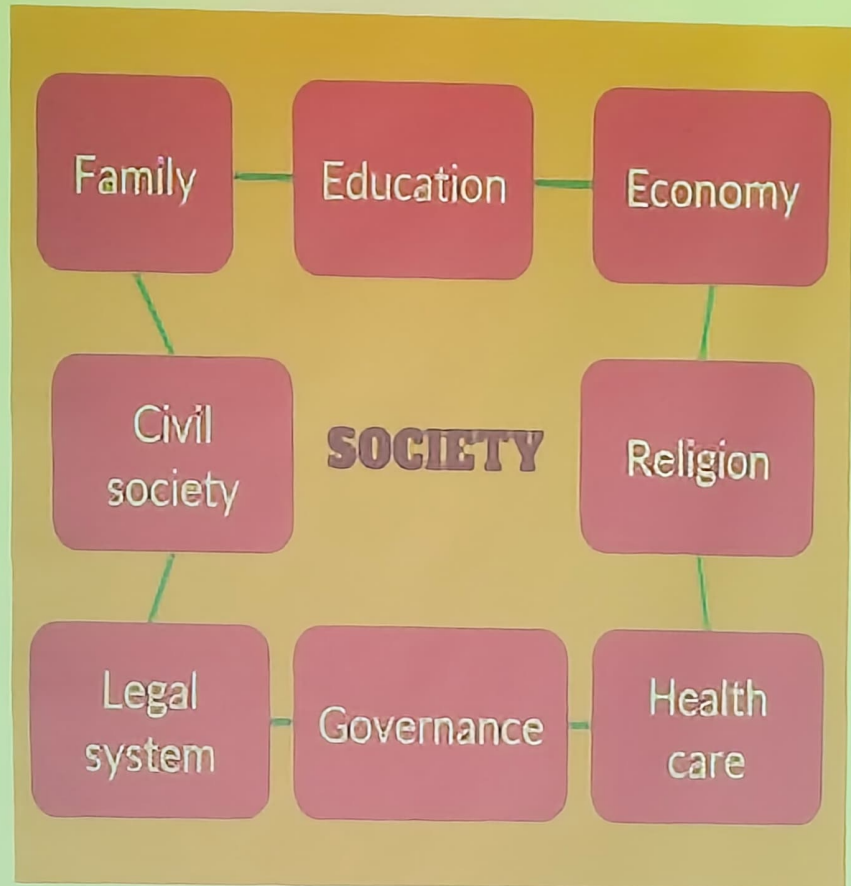


Planets
revolve
around the
Sun

View of society

“Society is a complex systems whose various parts work together to produce stability and solidarity”
(Giddens, 2009)

- Parts are interdependent
- Parts maintain the whole
- Emphasis on stability



Organic analogy

All organs **work** together
to maintain the **overall**
health of the human
body

**Society is like a
living organism**

All **parts** of society work
together to maintain the
'health' of the **whole**
society

If they don't, society
becomes **'sick'** or
unstable

Moral consensus

Moral consensus = Shared cultural values

Moral consensus is needed for harmony and stability in society

Harmony, stability, order and balance are desirable, 'normal' and 'healthy' for society



Manifest and Latent Functions

- Manifest functions - intended and known to participants
- Latent functions - unintended and unknown to participants

Example: Manifest and latent functions of school

Manifest function - Education



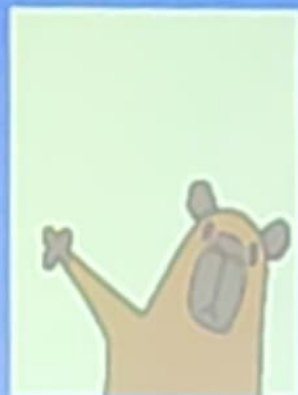
Latent function - formation of deep emotional bonds **between** friends



Symbols

What is a symbol?

"Something that stands for something else"



= HELLO!

"APPLE"

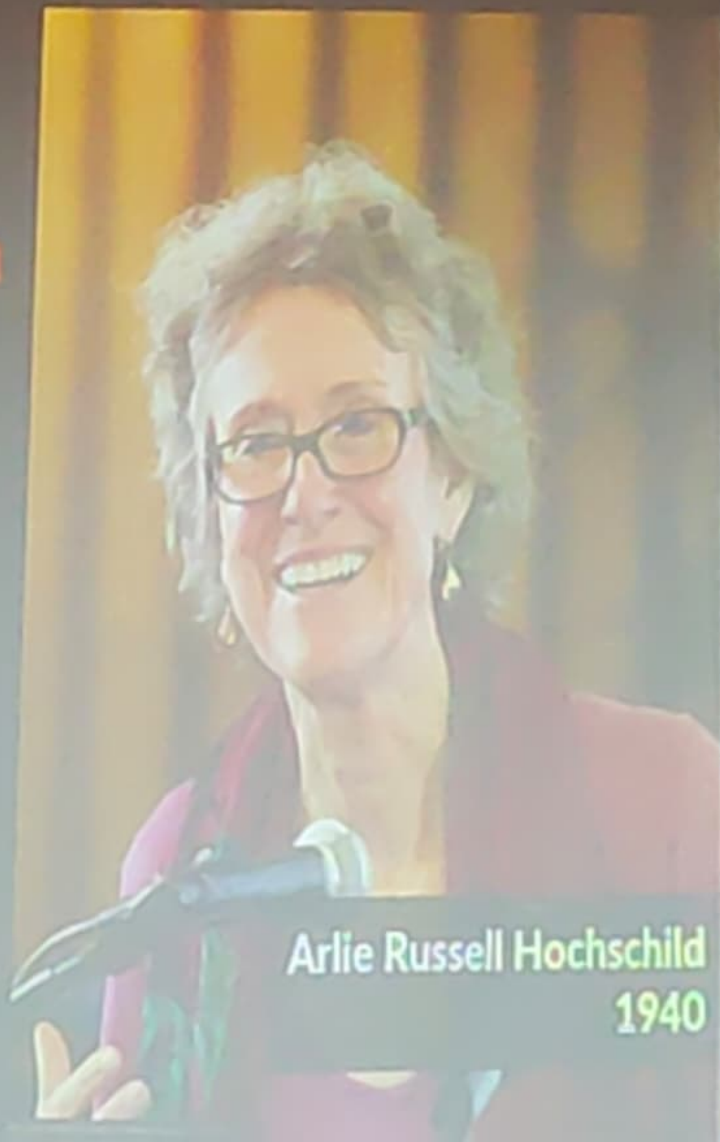
=



= HAPPY

The Managed Heart: The Commercialization of Human Feeling

- Human feelings are shaped by social norms
 - Appropriate emotions
 - Emotional labour -
- Management of emotions



Arlie Russell Hochschild
1940

Macro level analysis

Analysis of large-scale social systems like political and economic systems

Meso level analysis

Analysis of 'middle' level of society like social groups, communities, neighbourhoods, etc.

Micro level analysis

Analysis of everyday situations and interpersonal interactions





Auguste Comte

1798-1857

Born in France

Coined the term 'Sociology'

Witnessed great change in
French society during his
lifetime

Positivism

Scientific study of society

Use of scientific methods
to analyse social
phenomenon

Comte wanted to discover
universal laws of society

Society conforms to
invariable laws like the
natural/physical world
does

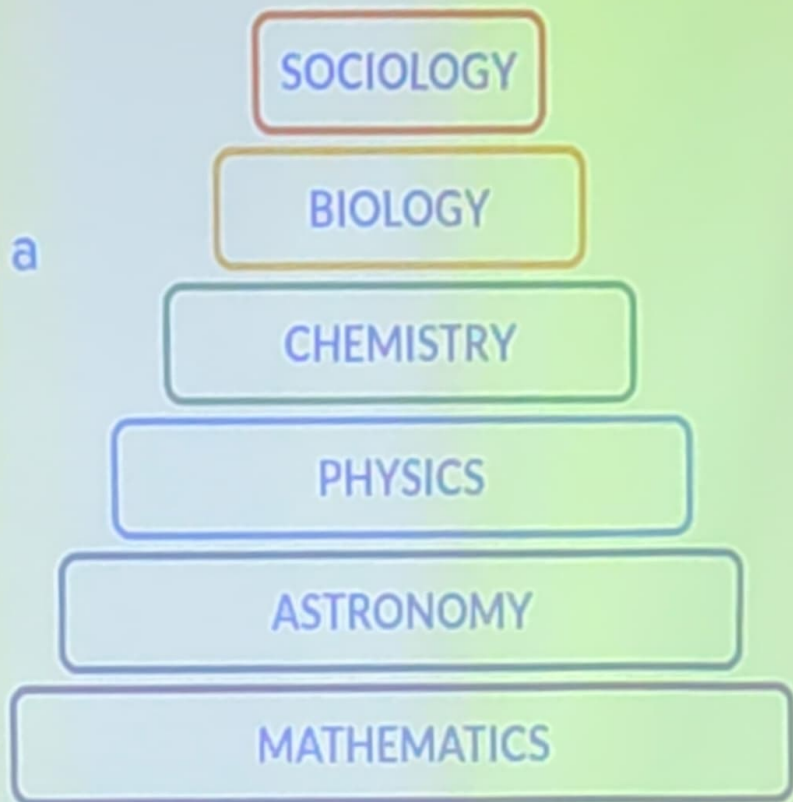
Law of three stages

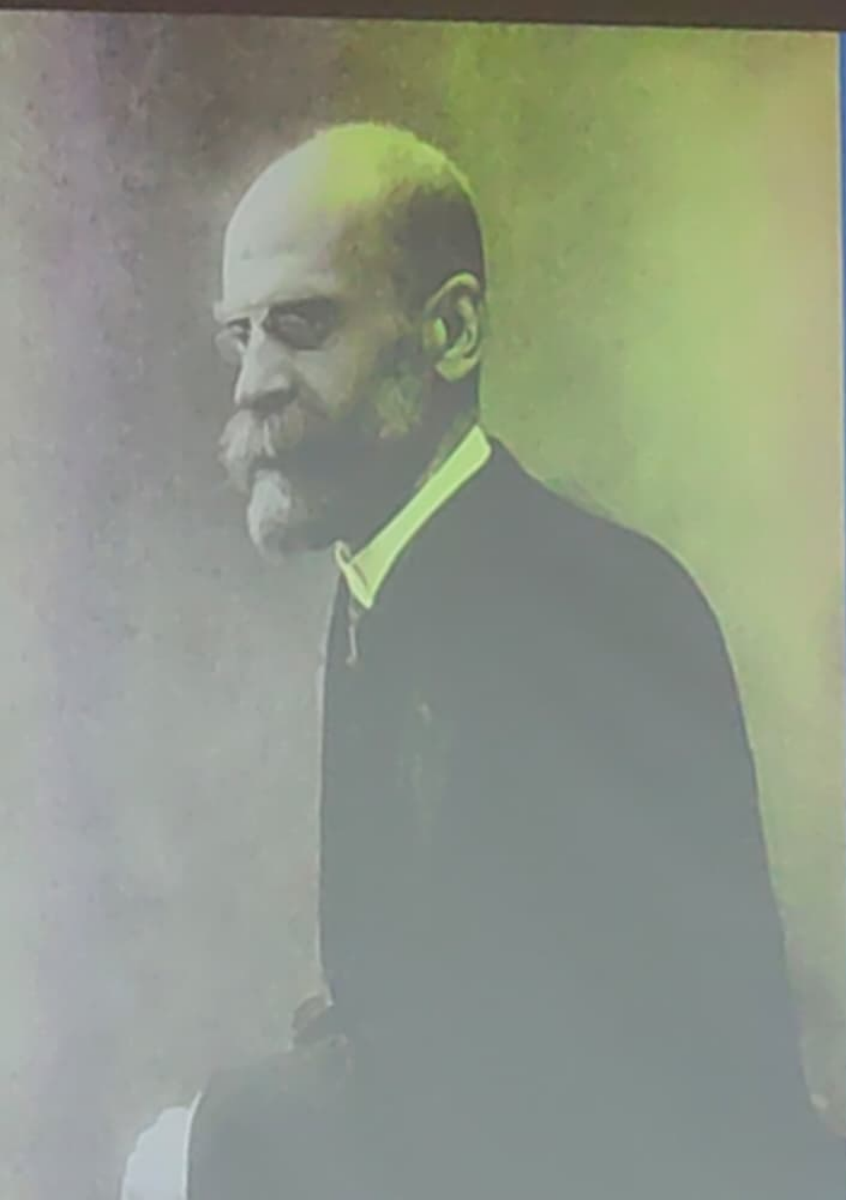
Society and human thinking go through three stages



The hierarchy of sciences

The sciences develop in a strict order





Emile Durkheim

1858-1917

Born in France

Functionalist + Positivist

**Study of society in empirical
manner**

Social facts

Social facts ways of acting, thinking or feeling that are

1. External to individuals
2. Coercive of individuals
3. Independence
4. Generality

Social facts are 'things'

Example 1: Family

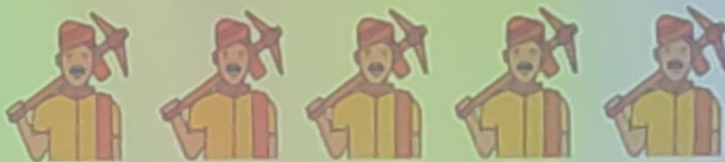


Example 2: Morality



The Division of Labour in Society (1893)

Pre-modern society - Low division of labour

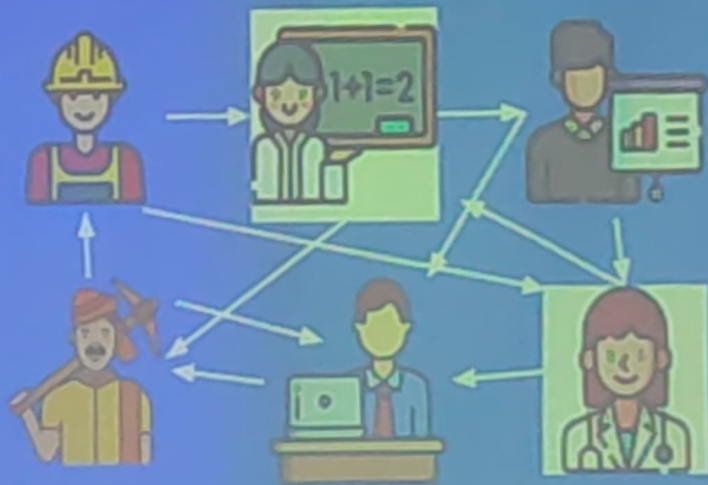


Similar opinions, ideas, morality, religious beliefs

Mechanical solidarity

Modern society - Differences and greater independence
Where does **solidarity** come from?

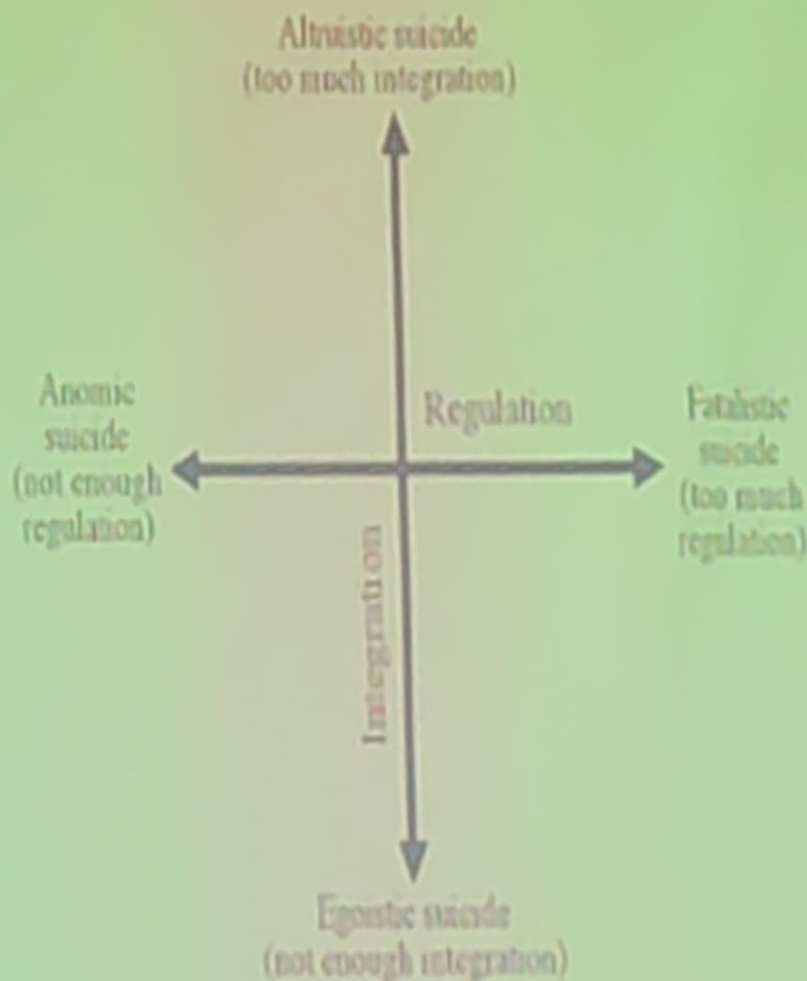
Division of labour -
Interdependence - **Organic solidarity**



Suicide (1897)

Durkheim analysed suicide rates

Suicides are caused by social factors like religion, marriage, fluctuations in the economy, etc.



Types of suicide

Egoistic suicide

Lack integration with society
No sense of belonging
Sense of isolation

Examples

- Unmarried men
- Protestants

Altruistic suicide

Too integrated with society
Suicide as sacrifice

Example

- Military persons
 - Japanese kamikaze pilots
-

Types of suicide

Anomic suicide

Lack of social regulation
Result of rapid change or
instability

Example

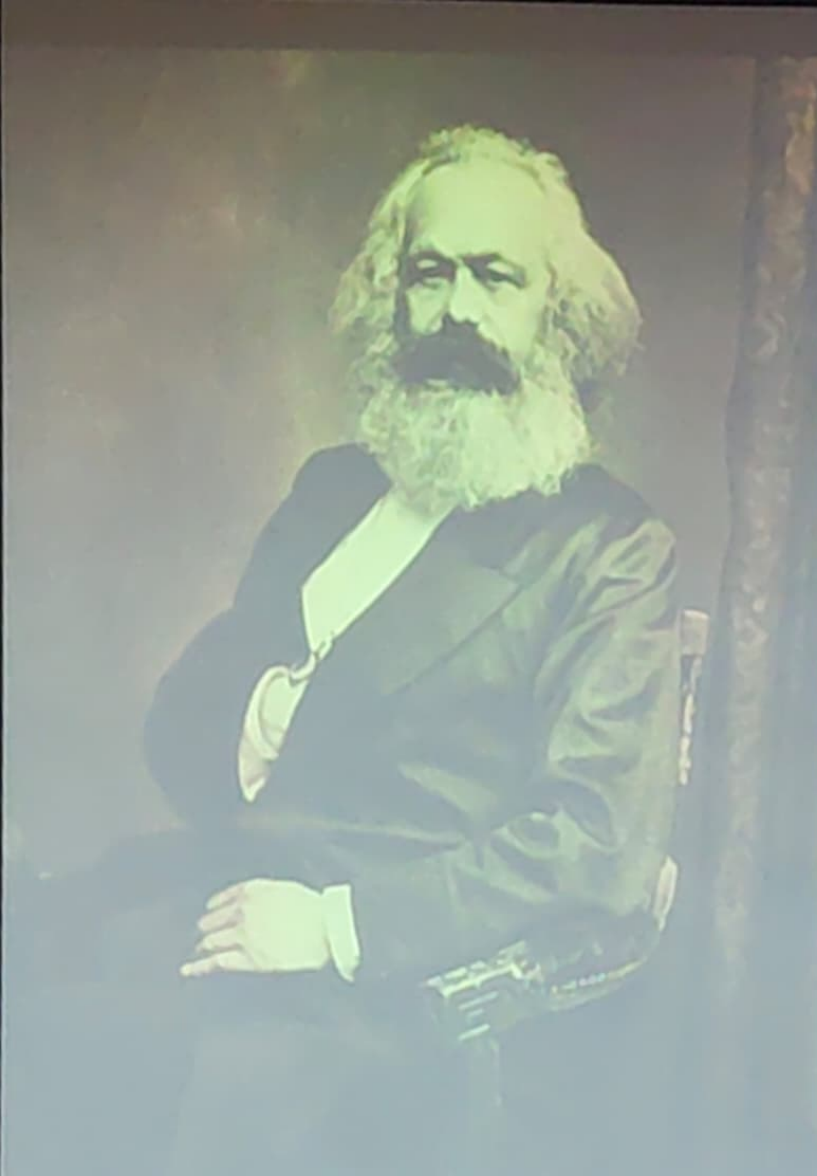
- Economic ruin
- Divorce

Fatalistic suicide

Too much regulation
Oppression by society
Hopelessness

Example

- Slaves
 - People in abusive relationships
-



Karl Marx

1818-1883

Born in Germany

Sought to explain changes
caused by the Industrial
Revolution

Conflict theorist

Capitalism

System of production that produces and distributes goods and services to large number of consumers

Capital

Money,
machinery,
factories

Wage labour

Workers who work
to earn wage

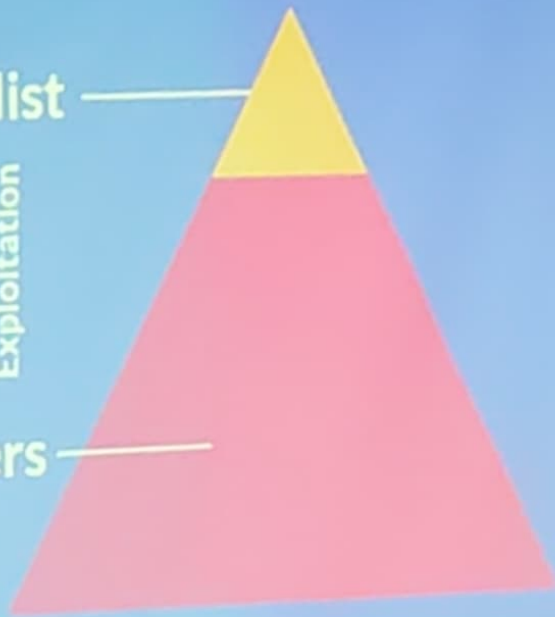
Class system

Capitalist

Domination

Exploitation

Workers



Class struggle

Conflict is inevitable
between capitalists and
workers

Marx encourages
workers to start a
revolution against
capitalists which will give
rise to **Communism**

The Communist Manifesto

**"The history of all
hitherto existing society
is the history of class
struggle."**

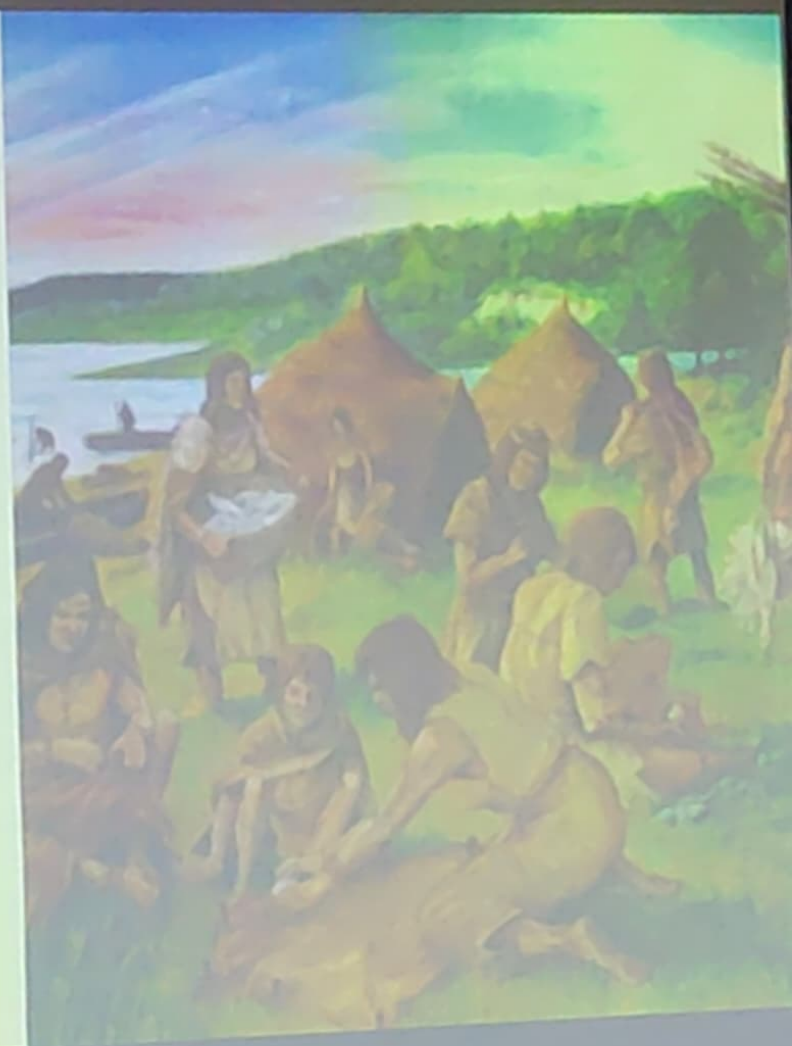
1848

Primitive communism

Mode of production -
Hunting-gathering

No private ownership of
property

No class division

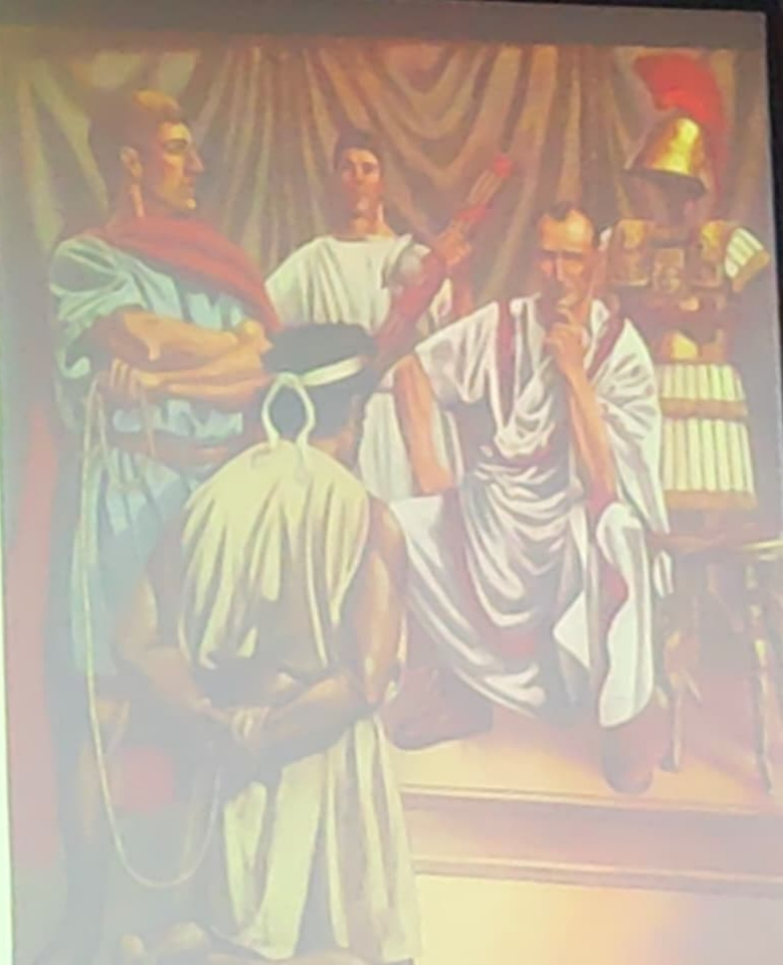


Ancient society

Mode of production -
Slavery

Development of agriculture
= development of private
ownership of property

Class division - Slaves vs.
Slave-owners

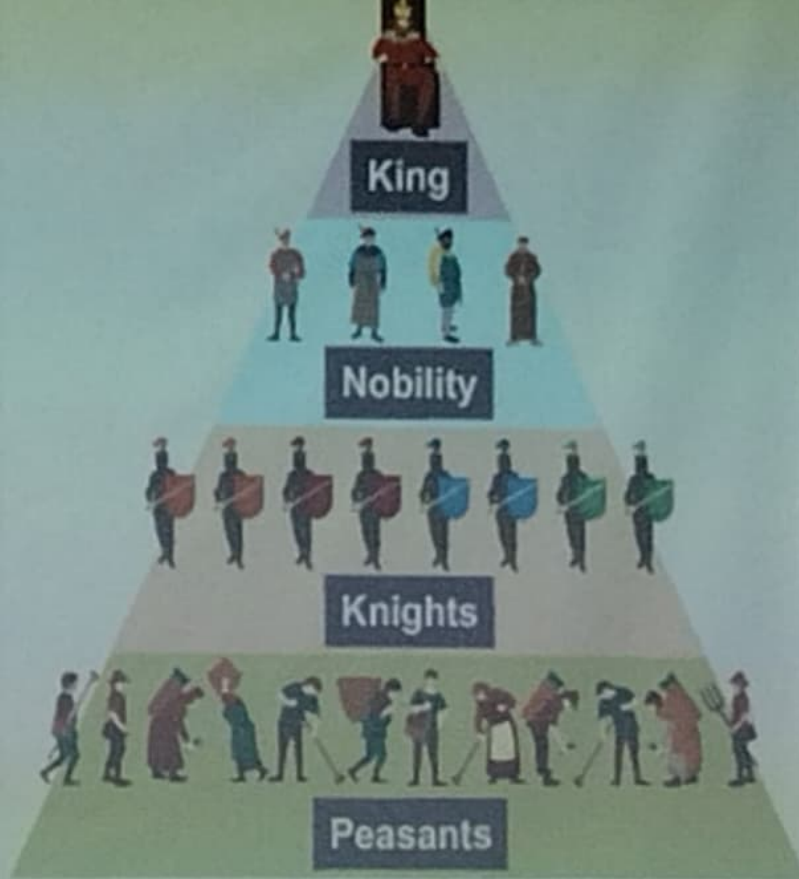


Feudal society

Mode of production -
Feudalism

Private ownership of
property like land

Class division -
Serfs/Peasants vs. Feudal
lords



Capitalist society

Mode of production -
Capitalism

Private ownership of means
of production - Money,
factory, machinery, etc.

Class division - Capitalists
vs. Workers



Socialist and communist society

No private ownership of means of production

Public ownership of means of production like factories, land, mines, etc.

No class division



The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism (1904)

Protestant belief system led to the development of capitalism in Europe

Protestant ethic of work

Hard work + frugal lifestyle = Capitalism

Indian and Chinese religious belief systems are not conducive to capitalism

Rationalization

Tradition, superstition,
religious beliefs, customs



Efficiency, calculation,
prediction

What is rationalisation?

The organisation of social
and economic life
according to the principles
of efficiency and on the
basis of technical
knowledge

Bureaucracy

A way of organising large number of people efficiently

1. Hierarchical
2. Rules and regulations
3. Specialised function
4. Impersonal
5. Merit and qualification

Disenchantment

Rationality rejects sentiment, mystery and wonder from life

We are stuck in an inescapable 'iron cage of rationality'

Class, Status and Party

Class = Economic class and property ownership

Status = Prestige in society

Party = Political party and connections

Has been used to study the caste system in India

Caste, class and party overlaps in India

Family in India

Outline

- 1.What is a family?
 - 2.Family and household
 - 3.Four substructures of the family
 - 4.Basic concepts:
Composition, Blood and marriage ties, Authority
 - 5.Zimmerman's classification of the family
-

What is a family?

As a social unit, a family is

- A group of persons of both sexes
- Related by marriage, blood and/or adoption
- With roles based on age, sex and relationship
- Forming a household or sub-household

As a reproductive/biological unit, a family is

- Composed of a man and a woman
- Having a socially approved sexual relationship
- Consisting of their offsprings

Some features of the family

- Socially approved sexual relationship between two adults
- Common residence
- Economic cooperation
- Reproduction

Household

People who live together in a single housing unit

May or may not be related by blood or marriage

May include more than one family

Hearth-group or *chulah*

Four substructures of the family

1. Ecological substructure -

Spatial arrangement,
geographical spread, household
type

2. Substructure of rights and
duties - Division of labour in the
household

3. Substructure of power
and authority - Control over
the actions of family members

4. Substructure of
sentiments - relationships
between members

Four substructures of the family

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between members

Basic concepts: family composition

Simple family

Consists of a man, his wife and their children

Compound family

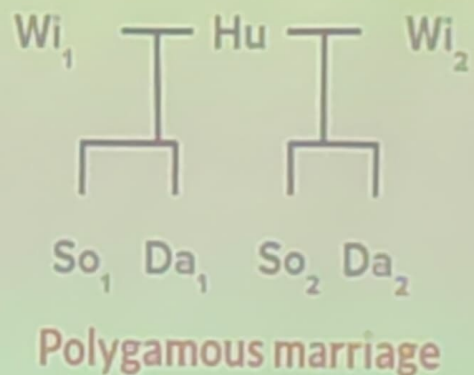
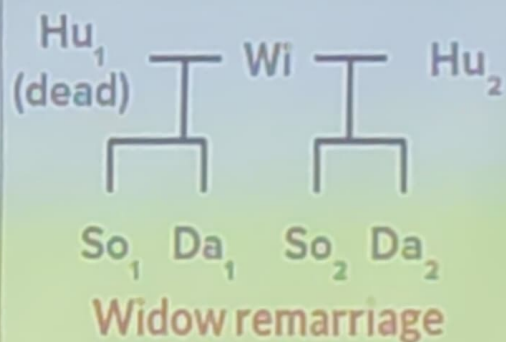
Consists three or more spouses due to death, remarriage or polygamy

Consists of at least two sets of children

One parent must be common in the two sets

Hu=Husband, Wi=Wife,
So=Son, Da=Daughter

Example: Types of compound families



Basic concepts: Blood and marriage ties

Consanguineal family

Priority is given to blood ties and the

The wife is considered an 'outsider'

The family continues even after the death of the parents as it is not dependent on any one couple

Conjugal family

Priority is given to marital ties over blood ties

The man leaves his parents to set up a new household

The family disintegrates with the death of the parents

Basic concepts: Authority

Husband-dominant family

Authority resides with the husband

Husband makes major decisions

Wife-dominant family

Authority resides with the wife

Wife makes major decisions

Egalitarian/Syncratic family

Authority resides with both

Major decisions are made by both

Autonomic family

Authority resides with both

Equal number of separate decisions are assigned to both

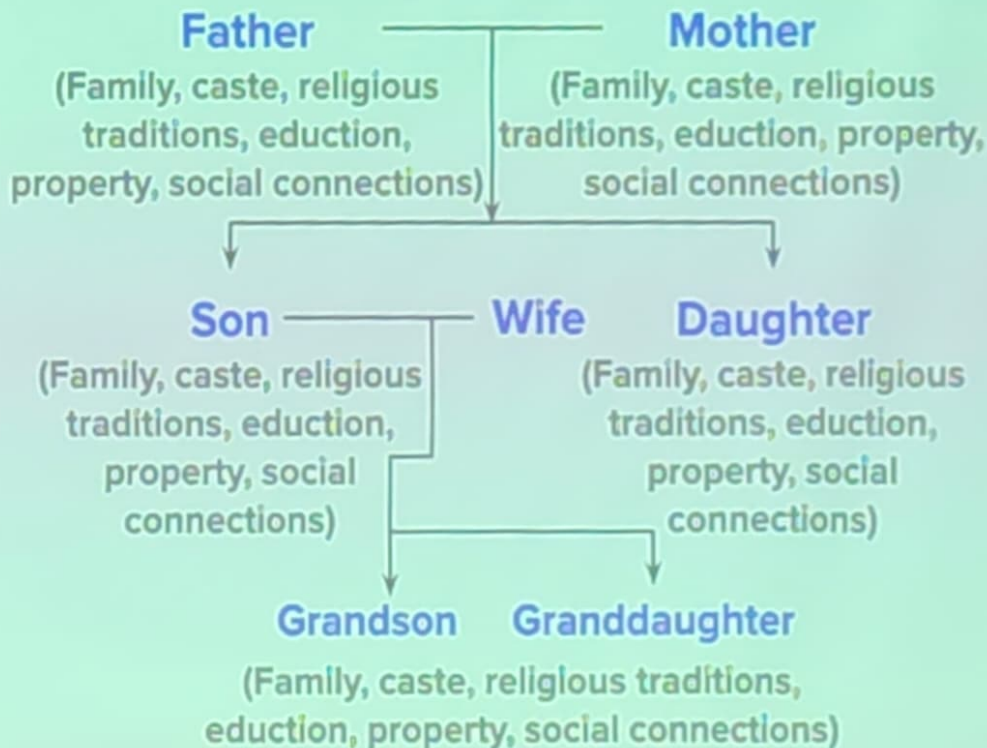
Characteristics of the joint family

- 1. Authoritarian structure** - Authority resides with eldest male of the family
- 2. Familistic organisation** - Subordination of the individual's interests to family's interest
- 3. Status in family** is determined by age, gender and relationship

What is social reproduction?

Transferring of culture, traditions and capital from one generation to the next

Takes place through family socialisation



Socialisation and social reproduction

Reproduction of
economic capital

Father/Mother
(Class position,
occupation, money,
land, commodities,
etc.)

Socialisation



Sons/Daughters
(**Reproduction** of class
position, money, land,
commodities, etc.)

Reproduction of
social capital

Father/Mother
(Social connections)

Socialisation



Sons/Daughters
(**Reproduction** of
social connections)

Reproduction of
cultural capital

Father/Mother
(Education, caste
position, language)

Socialisation



Sons/Daughters
(**Reproduction** of
education, caste
position, language)

Changing family patterns

Aileen Ross observations:

1. Increasing nuclearity and small joint family
2. Living in different family forms throughout lifetime
3. Distant relatives less important

Pauline Kolenda's observations:

1. Regional differences in family size and composition
2. Joint families more common in Gangetic plains
3. Joint families less common in Central and Eastern India

Emerging trends

1. Increasing nuclearity but members fulfill traditional obligations
2. Joint families more common in traditional communities
3. Size of joint family is smaller
4. Functional joint families more common
5. Neolocal residence - Conjugal couple lives separately
6. Equality of family members including women

Emerging trends

7. Joint mate selection - Love-arranged/Arranged-love marriages

8. Weakening family norms - Less particularistic, more Universal norms

9. Family actively reproduces inequality - Beteille suggests that in recent times caste has become passive, and family is the primary agent of reproduction of inequality

Forces of change

1. Education - increasing individuality and preparation for job market
2. Urbanisation - City life is not conducive to joint family life as members pursue their individual educational, occupation, religious, political interests
3. Industrialisation - Family transformed from unit of production to unit of consumption

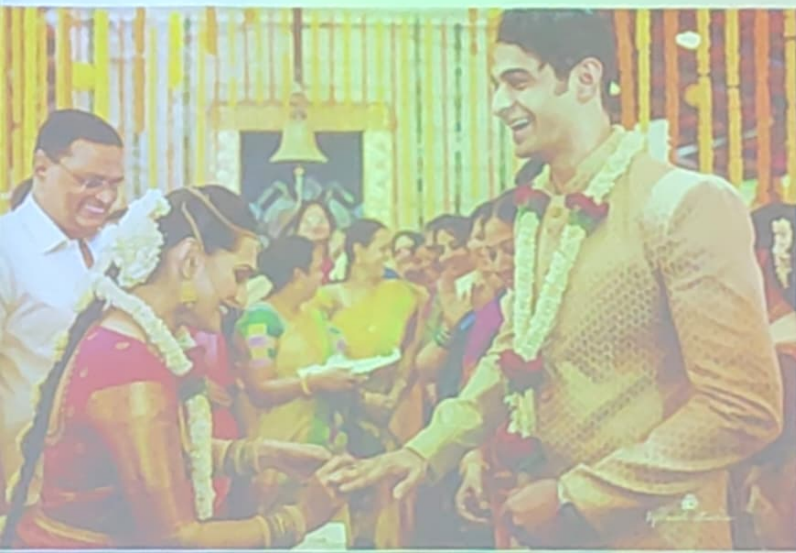
Kinship system in India

Outline

1. What is kinship?
 2. Families of orientation and procreation
 3. Kinship categories
 4. Classification of kinship terminology
 5. Teknonymy and fictive kinship
 6. Lineage and gotra
-

What is kinship?

A social relationship based on family relatedness

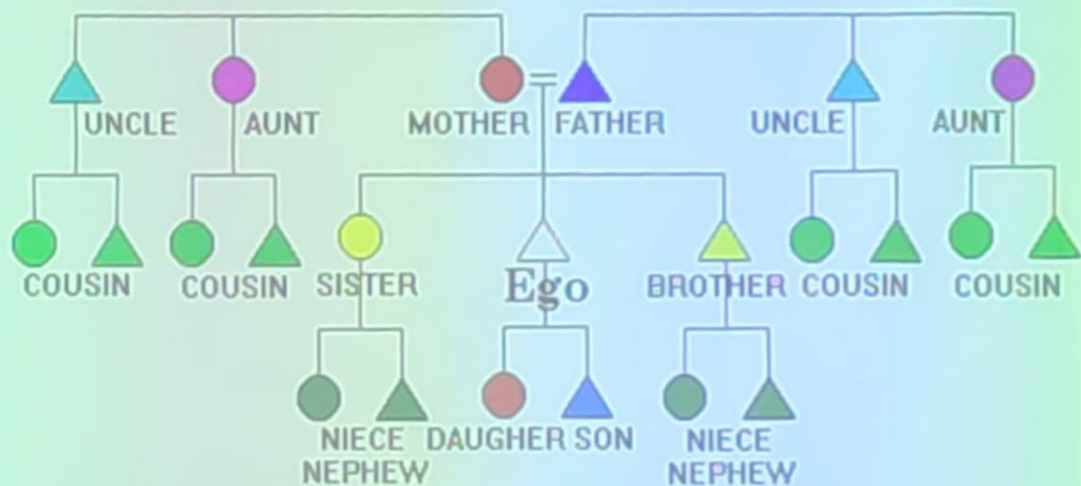


What is a kin group?

A group related by blood (consanguineal) or marriage (affinal)

What is a kinship system?

The customary system of statuses and roles that governs behaviour of people related by marriage or blood



Family of orientation

Family into which an individual (Ego) is born

Consists of consanguineal kin

Family of procreation

Family which an individual (Ego) establishes by marriage

Consists of both affinal and consanguineal kin

Kinship categories

Primary kin

Belong to Ego's nuclear families of orientation and procreation

Eg. Mother, Father, Brother, Sister in family of orientation

Husband, Wife, Son and Daughter in family of procreation

Secondary kin

Ego's primary kin's primary kin

They are not Ego's primary kin

33 types of secondary kin

Eg. Father's Father, Father's Mother, Mother's Father, Mother's Mother

Kinship categories

Tertiary kin

Primary kin of secondary kin

151 types of tertiary kin

Eg. Father's Father's Father,
Father's Father's Brother,
Mother's Father's Mother,
Mother's Brother's Sister

Distant kin

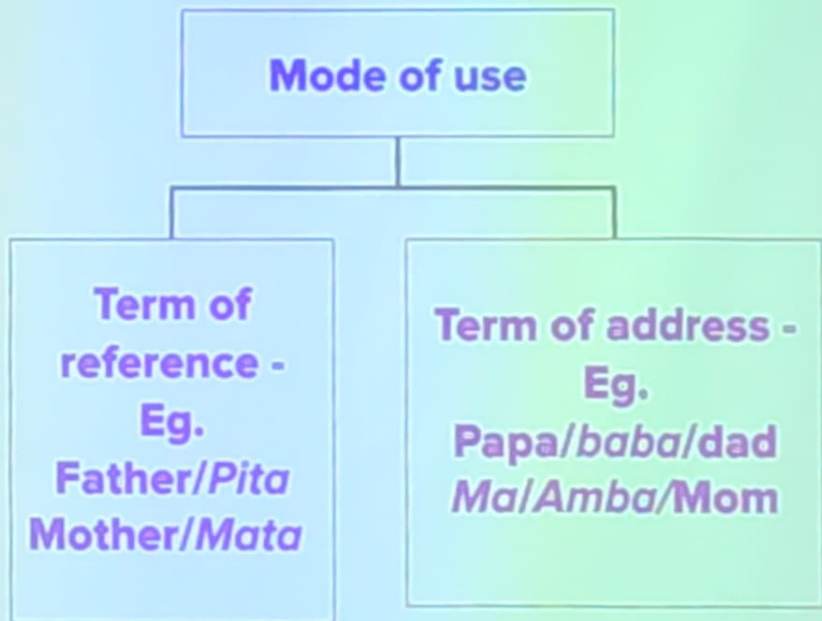
Primary kin of tertiary kin

Eg. Father's Father's Father's
Father, Father's Mother's
Father's Father

Classification of kinship terminology

1. Mode of use

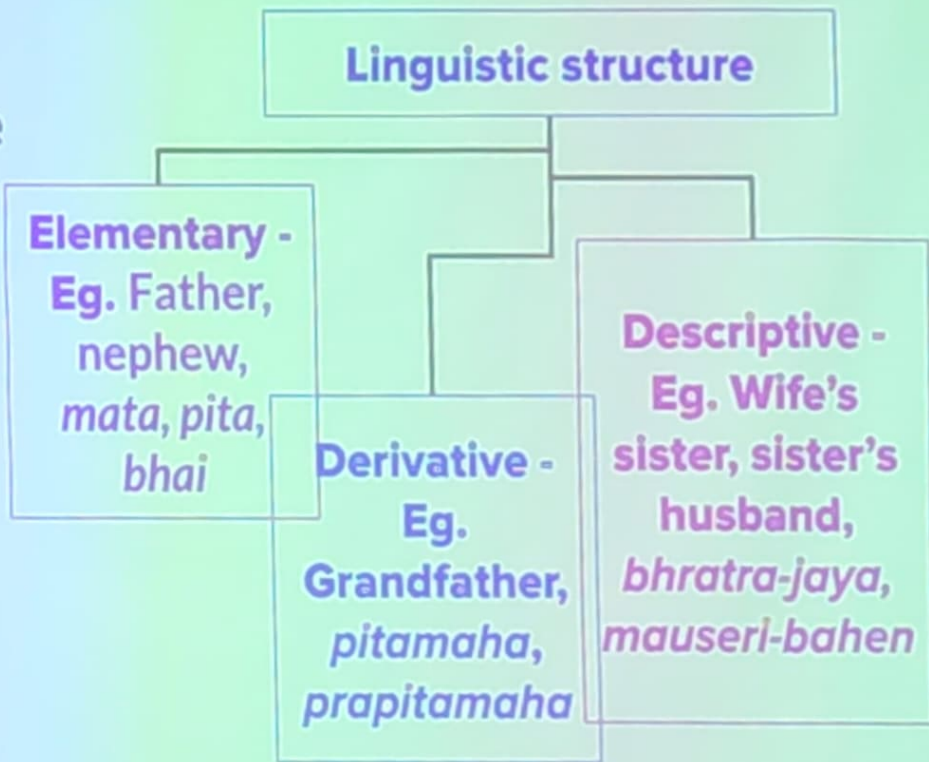
- Terms of reference to designate kin
- Terms of address for speaking with a kin



Classification of kinship terminology

2. Linguistic structure

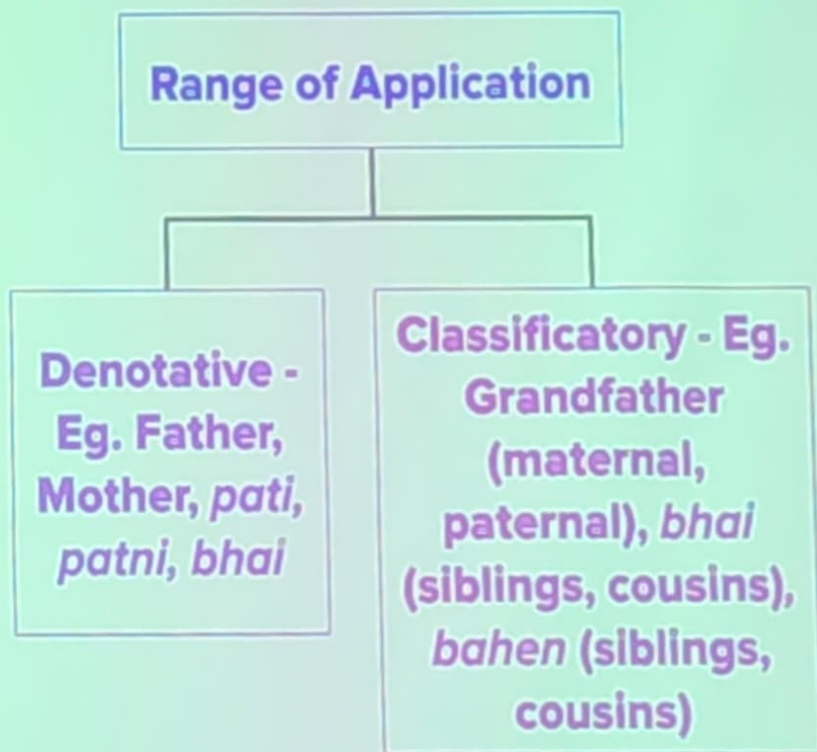
- **Elementary** - Can't be reduced
- **Derivative** - Compound of an elementary term
- **Descriptive** - Combines two or more elementary terms



Classification of kinship terminology

3. Range of application

- **Denotative** - Applies to one kin defined by generation, sex and genealogy
- **Classificatory** - Applies to two or more kinship categories



Teknonymy

Combining personal and kinship terms

Practice of referring to parents by children's name

Eg. Ram's father, Asha's mother

Fictive kinship

Quasi or pseudo kinship

Not consanguineal or affinal

Eg. Friend's parents are 'uncle' and 'aunty'

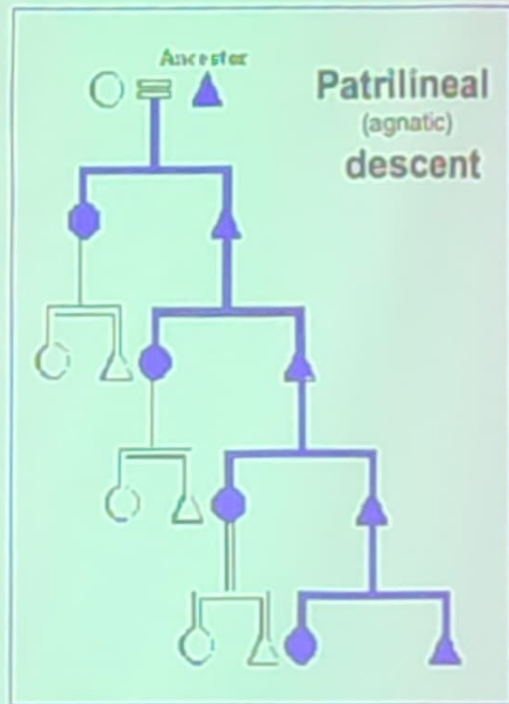
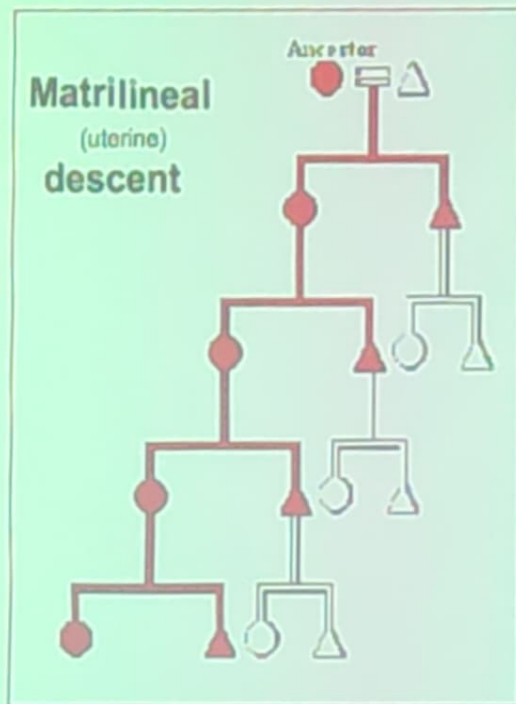
Older students in school are '*bhaiya*' or '*didi*'

Lineage

Consanguineous
unilateral
descent group

Traced from a
known and real
common ancestor

Also called *vansh*



Gotra

Unilateral kin group

Traced from a mythical common ancestor

Members are considered siblings

Exogamous - marriage outside the gotra

Gotra vs. Lineage

1. Larger, enduring over many generations
2. Inherited from the father
3. Supernatural or mythical origin story
4. Fraternal allegiance
5. Exogamous

1. Limited to several generations
2. Inherited from father, mother or both
3. Real common ancestor
4. Fraternal allegiance
5. Exogamous